

24 · INSTALLATION

Hyphal Column

The Whisper Network now has a **body**: a five-foot steel column with six screens and a tree hole inside. Whisper one sentence and a pixel spore grows. **Your sentence never shows on any screen — only the spore it grew.**

Cushions down, tower running, plush guardian on top. The wall text introduces Mycelium, the system it grows from. Visitors sit, whisper to the tower, and watch their spore drift into the colony beside everyone who sat there before them.

top	the plush guardian — the companion robot's seat
sky screen	the whole colony at night — every spore ever whispered, drifting
micro screen	one spore's record: name, family, intensity — the one being watched
pocket screens	twin ESP32 eyes — the spore picked from the field, live
field screen	the tree hole: type a sentence, a spore grows; QR to grow one on your phone
roster strip	the newest arrivals, in a row, by name

One Pi runs the screens; the tower's screens and the desk companion share a LAN bus, so a spore picked on the field goes live on the small screens the moment it is touched. **No accounts. No feed. No metrics.**

25 · DETAILS

Up close

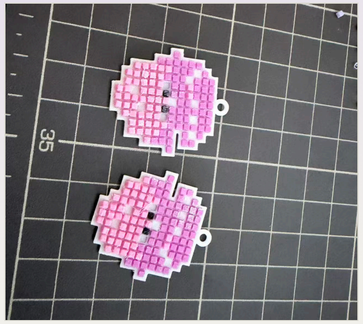


Details — the twin pocket screens, the spore field, the roster strip. The field runs inverted for the room: colour glows out of darkness; the web and phone experience stays paper-cream.

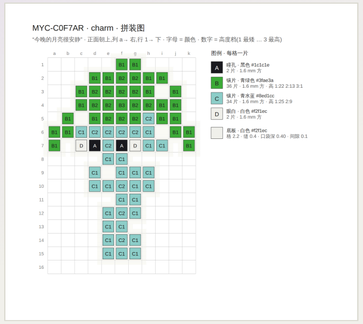
26 · OFF-SCREEN

Spore charms

Spores printed into charms, **tile by tile**. Every charm comes with its own build chart, and the assembly tray has numbered pockets and magnets — so a visitor's spore can go home as an object.



Printed charms, one pixel per tile.



Each charm's own build chart — letter = colour, number = height.

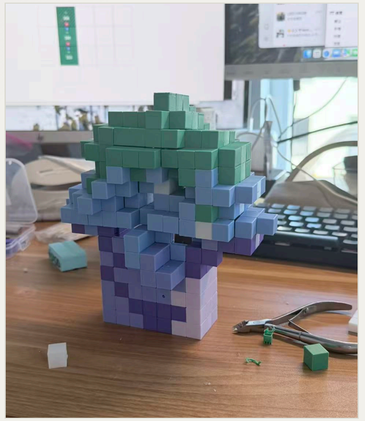


The assembly tray — numbered pockets and magnets.

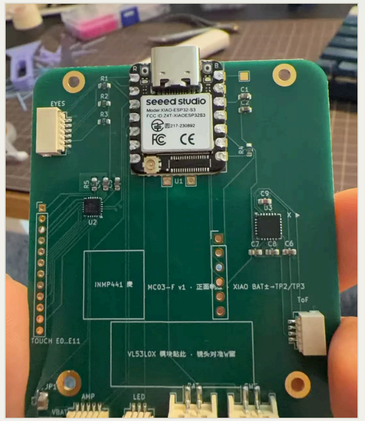
27 · IN PROGRESS

Desk companion

A desk companion robot on the **same network as the tower**: a spore body built from magnetic voxels, two pixel eyes, a tree hole of its own. Board v1 just arrived — **ESP32, mic, time-of-flight eyes, touch pads.**



The shell — a spore body built from magnetic voxels.



MC03-F v1: XIAO ESP32-S3, MPR121 touch, INMP441 mic, VL53L0X eyes, OLED sockets.

28 · SHOWN

BU Art Market

Fri, Oct 30, 2026 · 808 Commonwealth Ave, Boston

People sat on the cushions and whispered their sentences to the tower. Spores grew, and some went home as charms. Three visitors left an anonymous account of what the work left with them — their words, and how they felt right after writing (1–7):

> “I liked the way you can create a character based on how you feel and it can interact with other mycelium. I would like to see other ways to interact with mycelium. It’s a very creative idea and I love the software — super easy to use and very beautiful.”
>
> 13:11 · 18–29 · not in a transition
>
> ○○○○○○● harder to bear → easier to bear
> ○○○○○○● harder to put into words → easier to put into words
> ○○○○○○● more confused → clearer
> ○○○○○○● push it away → let it stay open

> “The colors and animations drew me in. I thought that this was such a cool concept and the idea of people influencing each other being depicted as “exchanging colors” is very sweet and touching.”
>
> 15:29 · 18–29 · in a life transition
>
> ○○●○○○○ harder to bear → easier to bear
> ○○○●○○○ harder to put into words → easier to put into words
> ○○●○○○○ more confused → clearer
> ○○○●○○○ push it away → let it stay open

> “人们之间的互动，but why things get so digitalized nowadays”
>
> 17:04 · 18–29 · in a life transition
>
> ○○○○●○○ harder to bear → easier to bear
> ○○●○○○○ harder to put into words → easier to put into words
> ○○○●○○○ more confused → clearer
> ○○○○○●○ push it away → let it stay open

Formative feedback, pre-IRB. The scales read the visitor's own state, not the work — the warmest words came with the lowest numbers, which is what they are for. Grow one now → mycelium.yueyao.design